

Skills

Assessing Pain

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Verified the health care provider's orders.	☐	☐	☐	
Gathered the necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene.	☐	☐	☐	
Provided for the patient's privacy.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to the patient and family.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified the patient using two identifiers.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that he or she agreed to treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed the patient's risk for pain.	☐	☐	☐	
Asked patient if he/she had any pain/discomfort. Assessed the patient's current pain using an organization-approved pain scale.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed patient's response to previous pharmacological interventions. Determined the patient's previous responses to analgesics.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed the patient for physical, behavioral, and emotional signs and symptoms of pain.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed the characteristics of the patient's pain. (Followed agency policy regarding what pain scale to use and the frequency of the pain assessment.)	☐	☐	☐	
Used a visual analog or Likert scale, if needed.	☐	☐	☐	

Used the PQRSTU mnemonic to assess patient's pain.

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Examined site of the patient's pain or discomfort when possible. Inspected the area for discoloration, swelling, or drainage. Palpated the area for any temperature change, altered sensation, pain, or areas that trigger pain. Observed the range of motion (ROM) of any involved joints. Used percussion and auscultation when necessary to identify abnormalities.

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As part of follow-up care, provided pharmacologic and non-pharmacologic pain or complementary relief measures.

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Reassessed the patient's pain an hour later.

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Helped the patient into a comfortable position maintained proper body alignment, and placed toiletries and personal items within reach.

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Placed the call light within easy reach, and made sure the patient knew how to use it to summon assistance.

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Raised the appropriate number of side rails and lowered the bed to the lowest position.

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Disposed of used supplies and equipment. Left the patient's room tidy.

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Removed and disposed of gloves, when used. Performed hand hygiene.

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Documented and reported the patient's response and expected or unexpected outcomes.

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Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____